A DESIGNER'S REVIEW

Claude Design

Karen Shen · April 2026

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What's Claude Design

01

Visual-First GUI

Chat on the left, live canvas on the right.
No CLI. Powered by Claude Opus 4.7.

02

From Idea to Artifact

Generate prototypes, slides, one-pagers. Export to PDF, PPTX, HTML, or Canva.

03

Team-Ready Design System

Claude reads your code and design files, then builds a shared system for every project.

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Let's start with the questions most people care about.

Q1	**What's the difference between Claude Code and Claude Design?**	The GUI-vs-CLI story
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Q4	**Do we still need Figma?**	Design tool vs. production tool
※	**Hands-on walkthrough**	A designer's first run
→	**What's next**	Long-term outcomes

Q1

QUESTION 01

What's the difference between Claude Code and Claude Design?

ANSWER 1

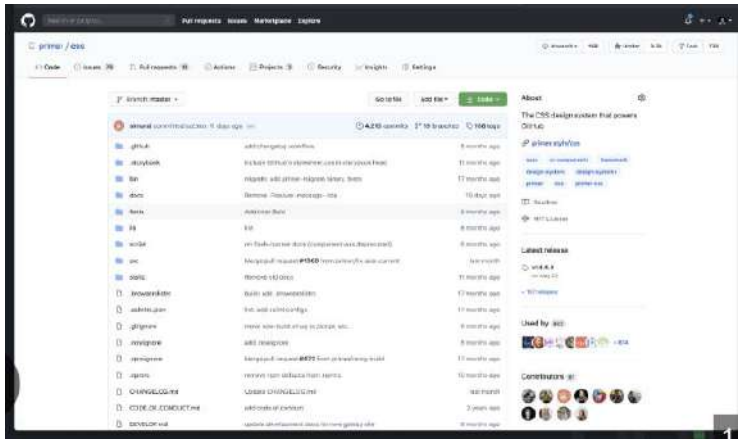
Claude Design : Claude Code ≈ GitHub Desktop : GitHub

A simplified GUI covering the daily 80% — the rest stays in the full tool.

GITHUB · FULL

```
$ git init
Initialized empty Git repository in /tmp/tmp.IMBYSY7R8Y/.git/
$ cat > README << 'EOF'
> Git is a distributed revision control system.
> EOF
$ git add README
$ git commit
[master (root-commit) e4dcc69] You can edit locally and push
to any remote.
 1 file changed, 1 insertion(+)
 crate mode 100644 README
$ git remote add origin git@github.com:cdown/thats.git
$ git push -u origin master
```

GITHUB DESKTOP · GUI

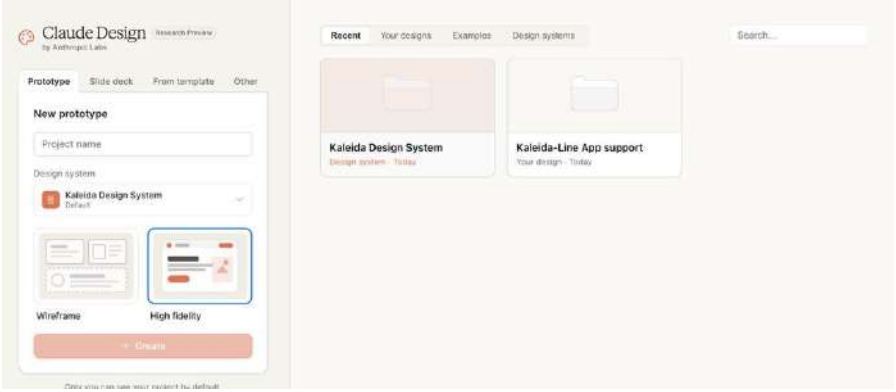


CLAUDE CODE · CLI

```
$ claude "design a pricing page"
● Reading /App.jsx
● Writing /Pricing.jsx
✓ preview at localhost:3000
```

≈

CLAUDE DESIGN · GUI



How Claude Design Compares

	Claude Design	Figma Make	Google Stitch
Launched	2026-04-17 (research preview)	GA since 2025-07 (publishing still beta)	Stitch 2.0: 2026-03; Gemini 3: 2025-12
Model	Claude Opus 4.7	Claude Sonnet 4.5 / GPT-4o / Gemini 2.0 Pro (selectable)	Gemini 3 (default); Gemini 2.5 Pro / Flash (legacy)
Interface	Chat + Canvas (web app)	Inside Figma canvas	Standalone web + infinite canvas + voice
Design system	Auto from codebase + design file uploads	Make kits (Figma library: variables, tokens, styles)	DESIGN.md + URL extract (tokens + patterns)
Engineering impact	Outputs polished HTML / CSS; engineers rebuild using repo components	Same as Figma handoff; Make kits carry tokens to reduce drift	DESIGN.md commits to repo for coding agents; multi-framework code as reference
Portability	Proprietary (Anthropic-only)	Figma ecosystem only	Portable: DESIGN.md + MCP to other agents
Output	PDF / PPTX / HTML / Canva / Claude Code handoff	Figma files + code snippets	HTML, CSS, Tailwind, Vue, Angular, Flutter, SwiftUI
Price	Pro / Max / Team / Ent (with quota)	Seat-based (≈50–100 prompts / mo)	Free (350 Flash + 200 Pro / mo)

Universal gap — outputs a spec, not shipping code.

Q2

QUESTION 02

How can Claude Design help us?

ANSWER 0

A designer-friendly alternative to Claude Code.

Lower the learning curve. Same engine, lower barrier.

Let designers ship prototypes without becoming terminal users.

- No CLI. No Git. Just a canvas and a chat box.
- Pre-built scaffolding: design system import, design-decision prompts, export paths.

Pain Points with Code-First AI Design

Traditional Figma

Wireframe → Hi-Fi → Prototype → Handoff. Mature, visual, familiar.

Claude Code

CLI → prompt → code → run → tweak.

Powerful, but lives in the terminal.

The Gap

CLI barrier. Git curve.

Rendering overhead. Hard to tweak fine detail via text alone.

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In short

Claude Design provides an easy way to adopt AI for UI delivery

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What Claude Design Solved

Pain		Solved by Claude Design
CLI barrier	→	**GUI, not a CLI** Zero terminal.
Zero-to-one scaffolding	→	**Design system auto-built** from codebase + design files.
Hard to tweak fine detail	→	**Direct UI edits** Wording, font, colors, sliders.
Rendering overhead	→	**Talk + one-click preview** See the result instantly.
File / output management	→	**Canva / PPTX / HTML export** Plus handoff to Claude Code.

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Q3

QUESTION 03

Does Claude Design improve the quality of design delivery?

ANSWER 03

Yes and No

WHY?

Harness stays thin.

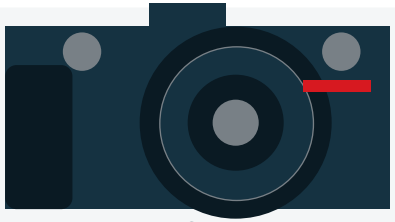
No persistent docs. No git. No versioned tokens.

Collaboration stays shallow.

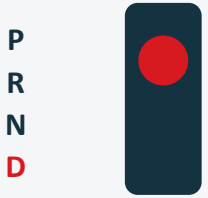
No skill/settings share. No way to work with monorepo. No decision trace.

→ So it can't consistently deliver designs across time or across teams.

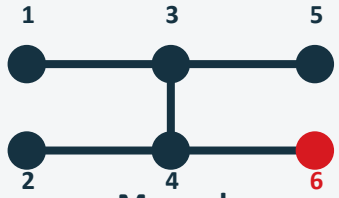
Point-and-shoot
傻瓜相機



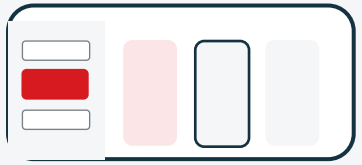
DSLR
單眼



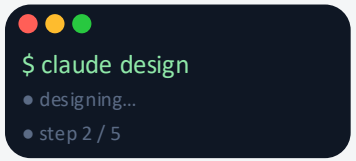
Automatic
自排車



Manual
手排車



Claude Design
GUI



Claude Code
CLI

Low barrier · High ceiling

Q4

QUESTION 04

Do we still need Figma?

ANSWER 04 · YES, FOR NOW

Yes — they do different jobs.

CLAUDE DESIGN

Design delivery tool

Fast mockups · prototypes · slide / one-pager output

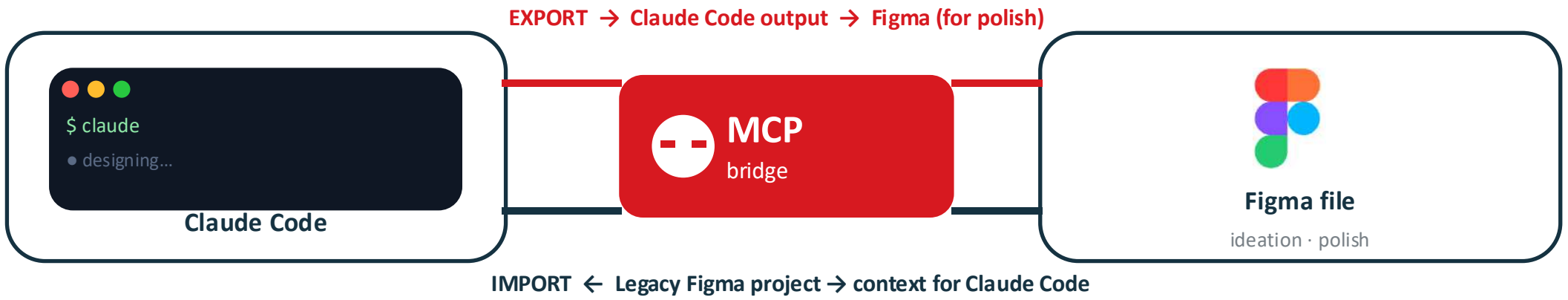
AI-generated scaffolding · one-click variations

FIGMA

Design tool

Ideation · detail polish · pixel-level craft

Shared component libraries · plugins · community



Photography didn't replace painting — both exist for different jobs.

Figma official skills

https://www.figma.com/community/skills

Design resources | Websites | Figma Make | Extensions | Whiteboarding | Presentations | Publish

Required skill

/figma-use

Start by downloading this foundational skill that teaches your AI agents what tokens, variables, styles, and components are and how to use them on the canvas.

Download from GitHub →

world-peas — zsh

```
› Build me a new component set based on my button.tsx file.
● Skills (figma-plugin:figma-use, figma-generate-library)
  └ Successfully loaded skills
● Read 3 files
● Button created with 72 variants
```

/figma-generate-design

Create new designs in Figma using existing components and variables.

By Figma

/figma-generate-library

Create new components in Figma from a codebase.

By Figma

/create-voice

Generates screen reader specs (VoiceOver, TalkBack, ARIA) from Figma components.

By Ian Guisard, Uber

/rad-spacing

Applies hierarchical spacing with variables and fallbacks.

By Nolan Perkins, Rad Collab

/apply-design-system

Connects existing Figma designs to published design system components.

By Chris Goebel, Edenspiekermann

/audit-design-system

Audits Figma screens for design-system integration drift.

By Chris Goebel, Edenspiekermann

/cc-figma-component

Generate Figma components from a structured JSON contract file.

/cc-figma-tokens

Generate Figma tokens from a structured JSON contract file.

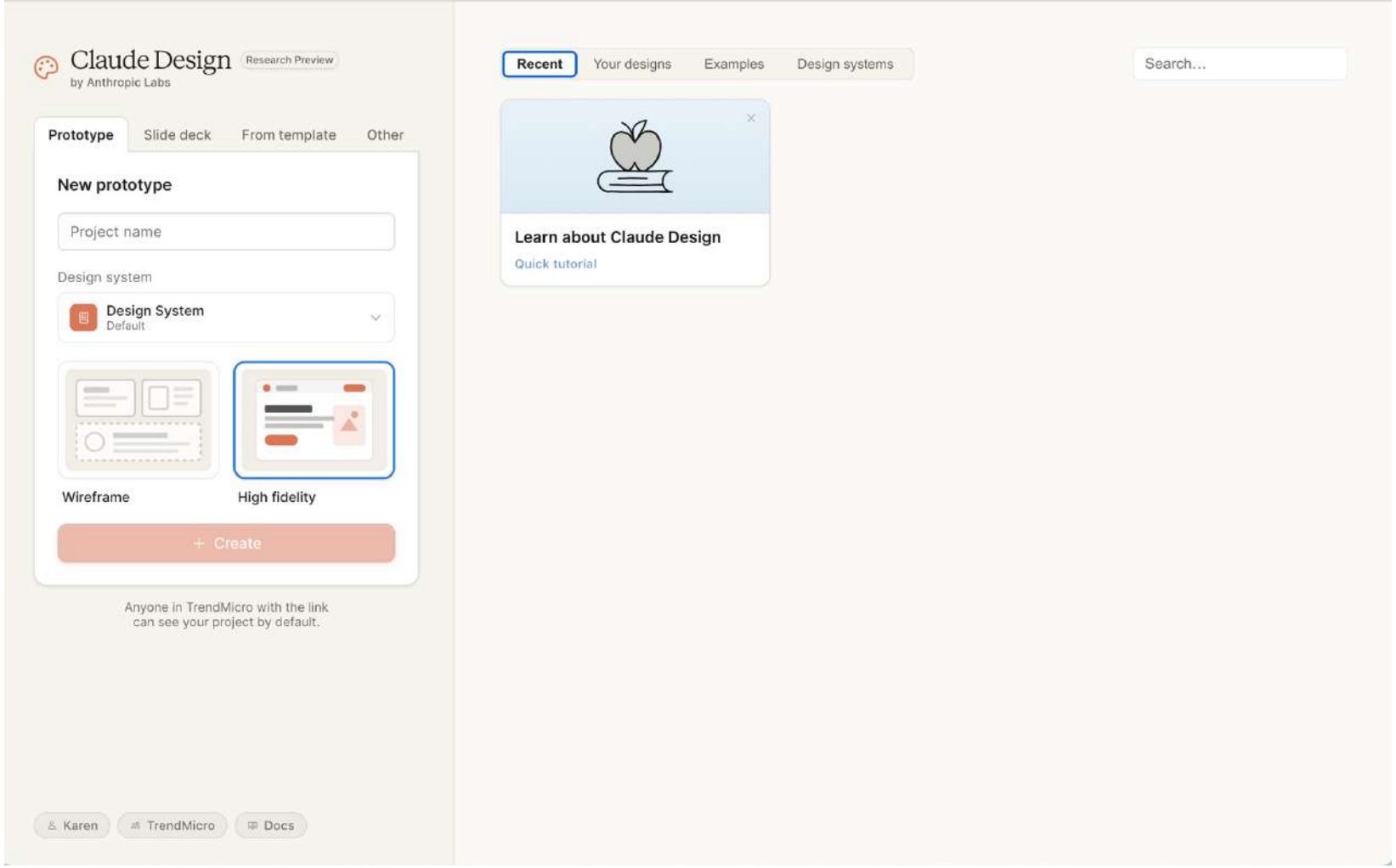
/edit-figma-design

Orchestrates Figma design workflows using Warp and Oz

Hands-on

Hands-on Claude Design

https://claude.ai/design/



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Design System

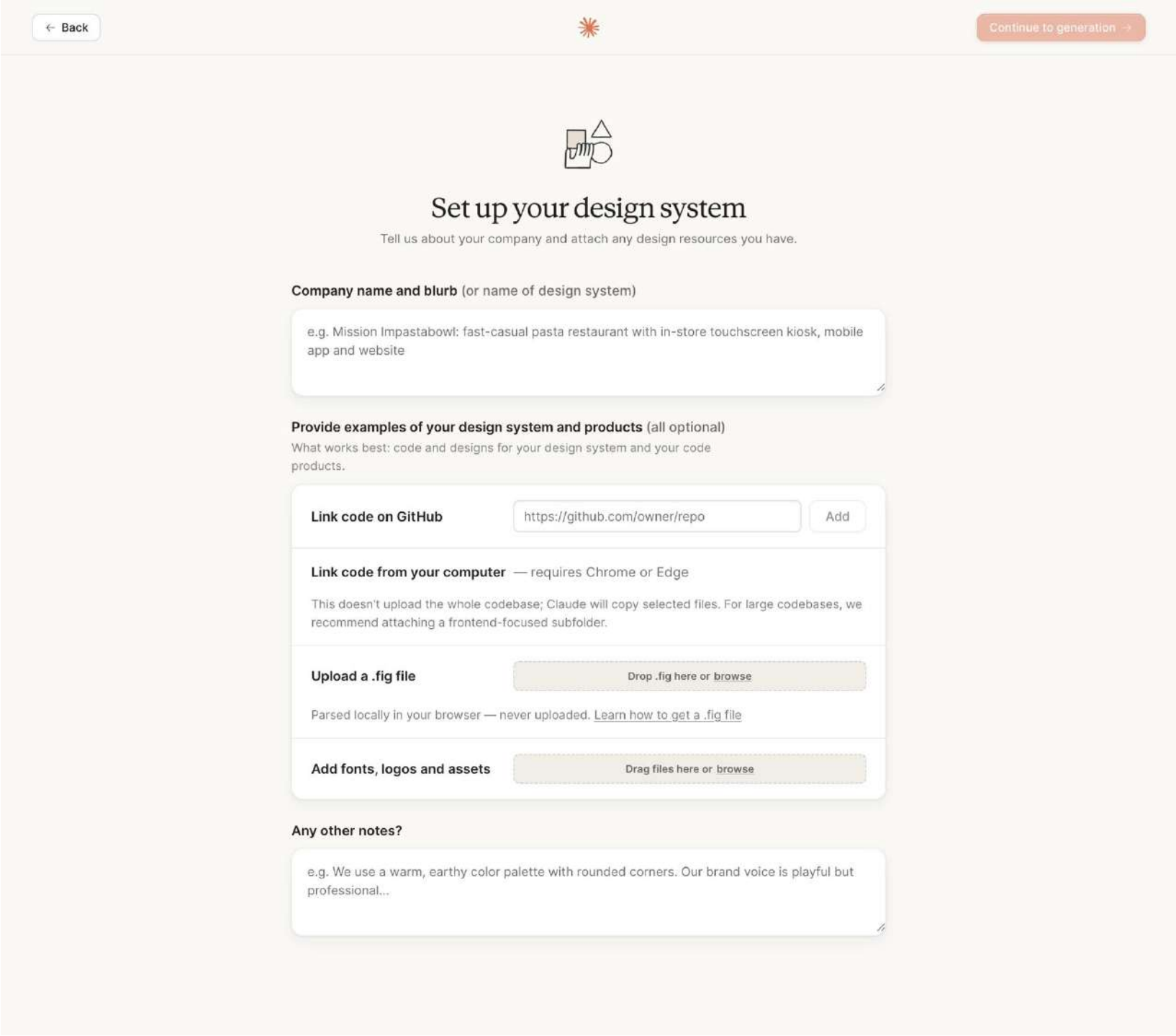
Design system

Supports 4 types of sources

- Github link
- Upload code
- .fig file (requires Save local copy from Figma)
- icon or fonts assets

Output

Wireframe/ High fidelity mockups/ Slides



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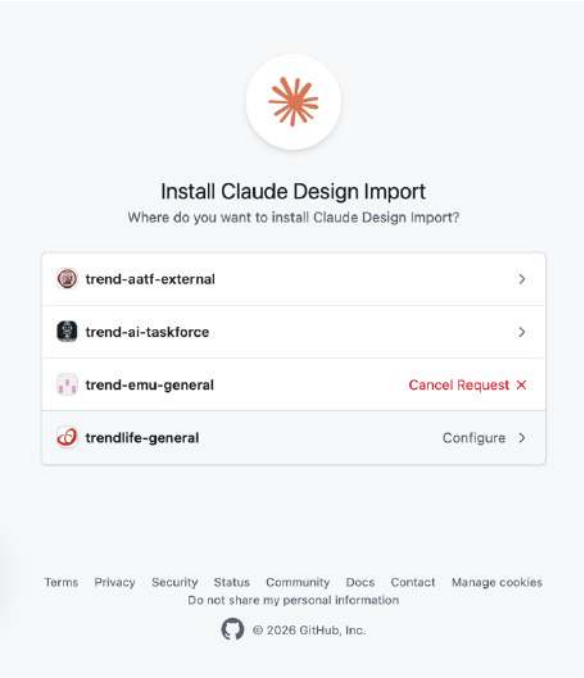
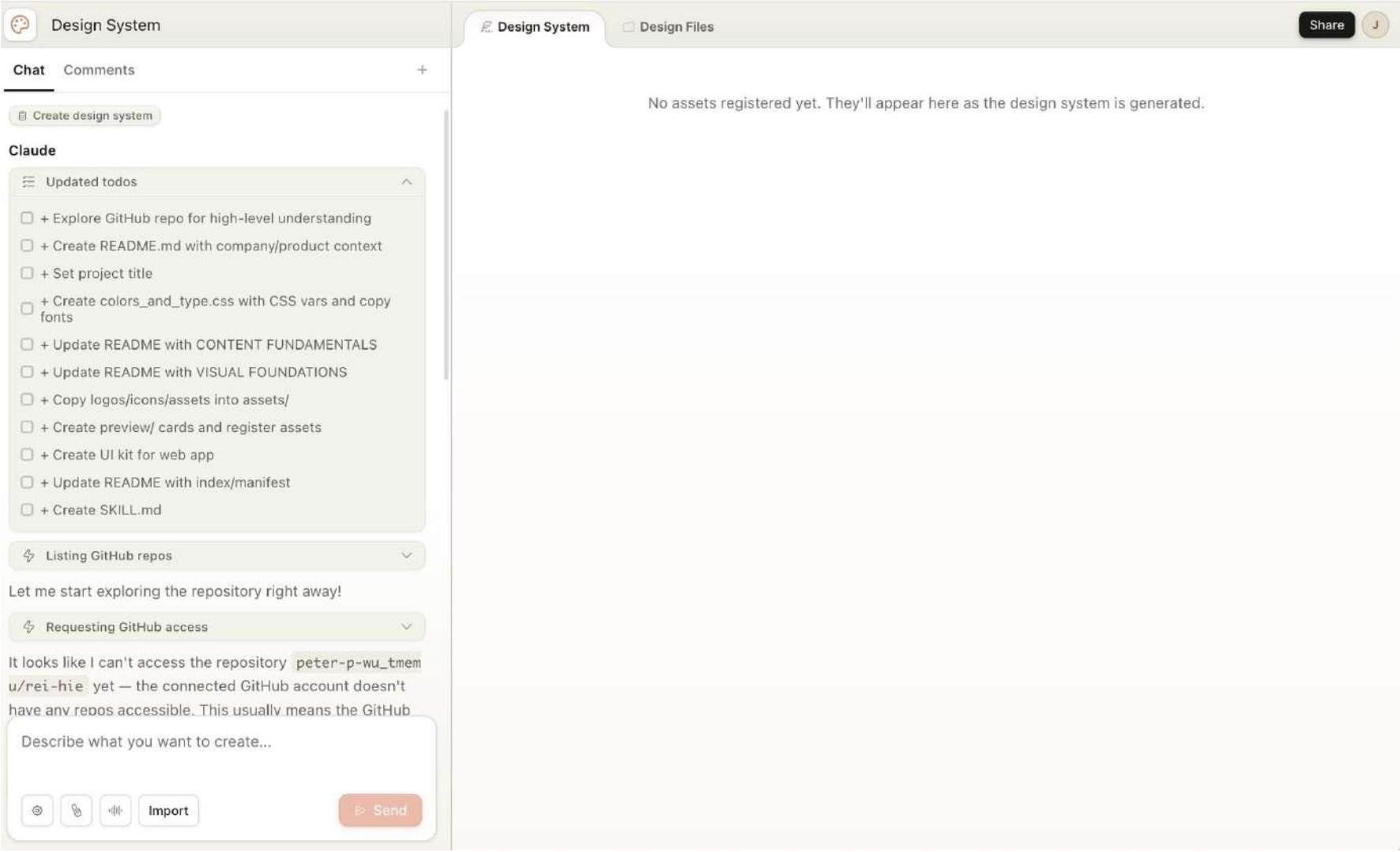
Design system import

Source: Github repo link

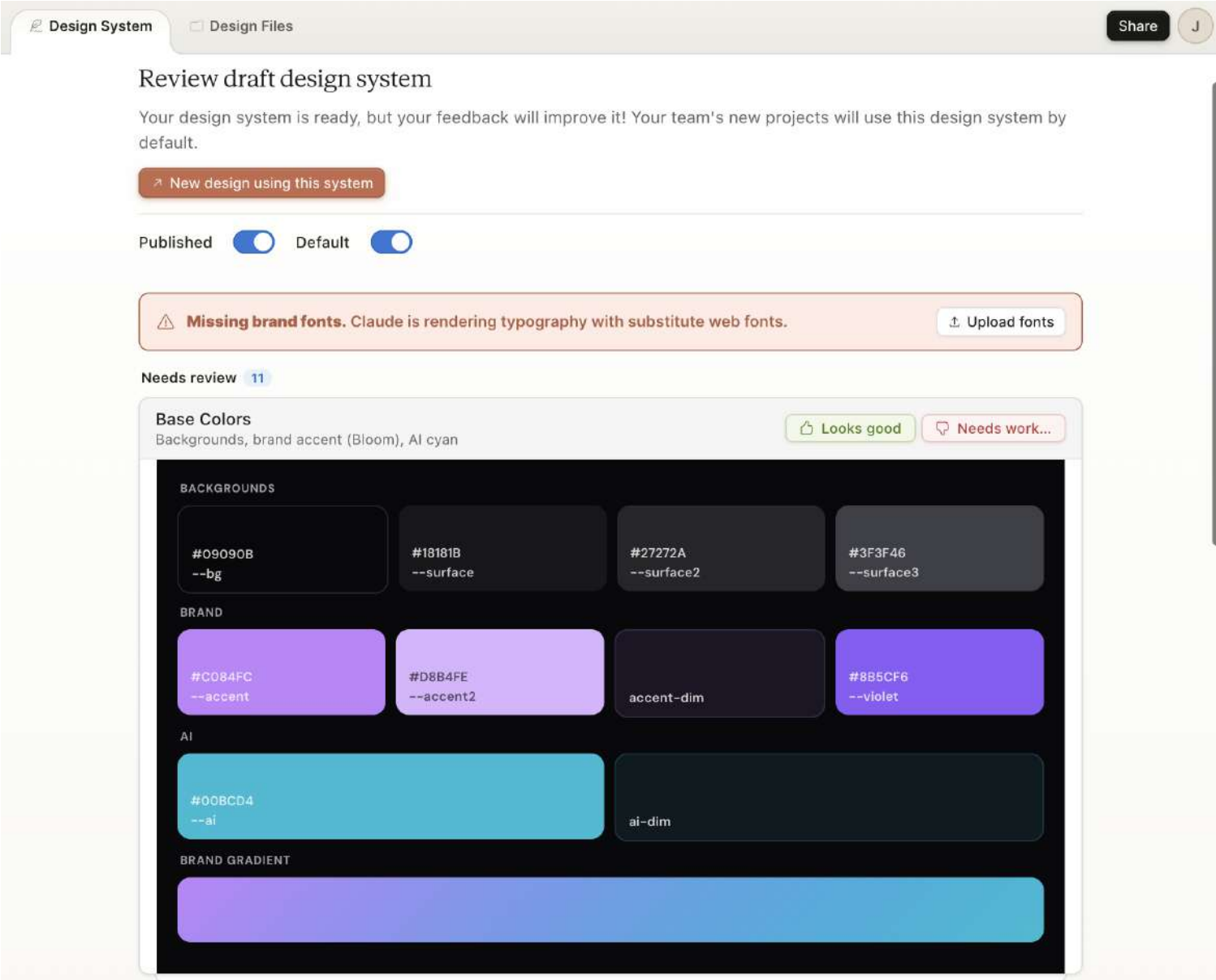
- Requires org admin to grant permission
- Repo = public



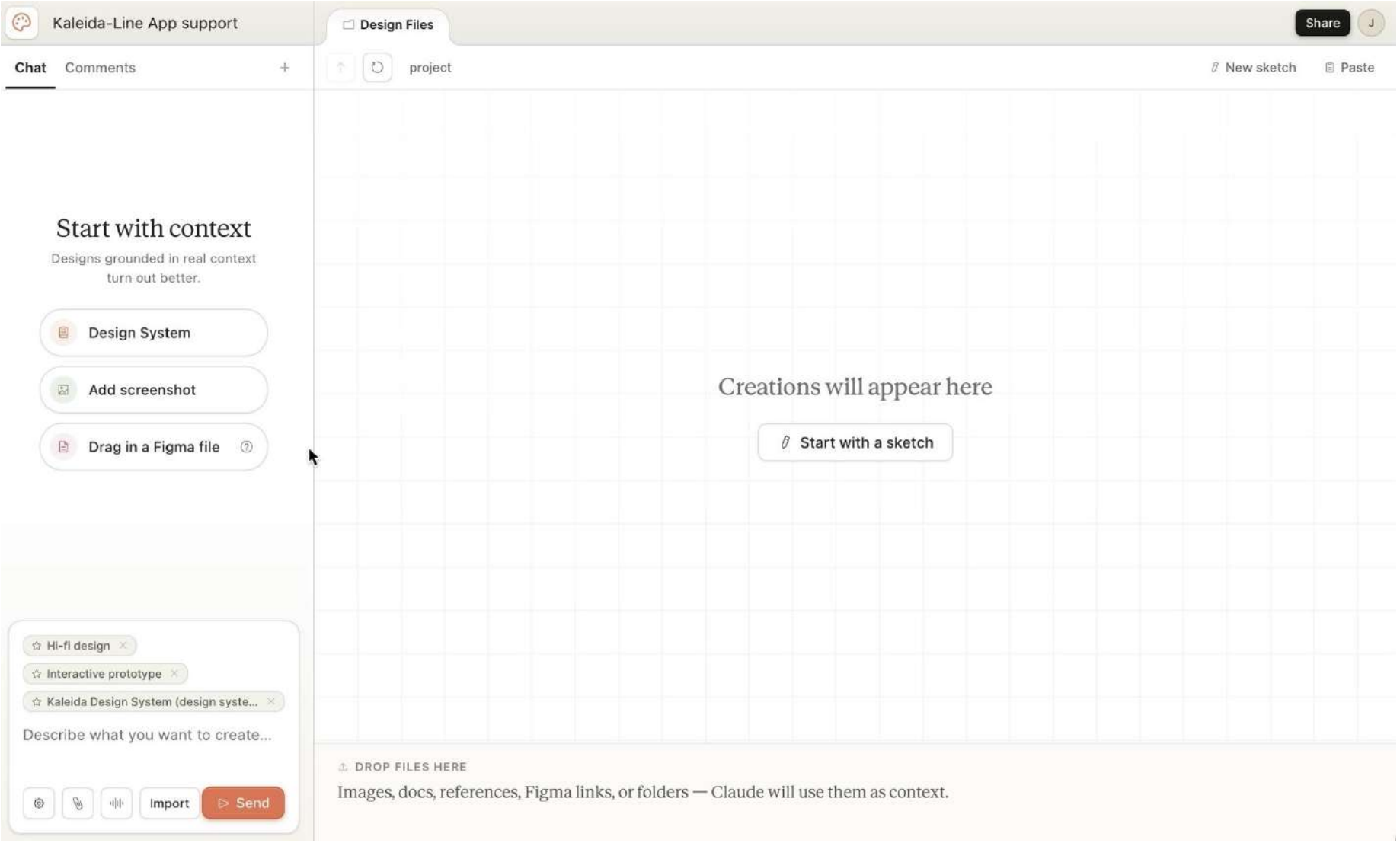


Design system import - result

Manually adjustable



Start to design



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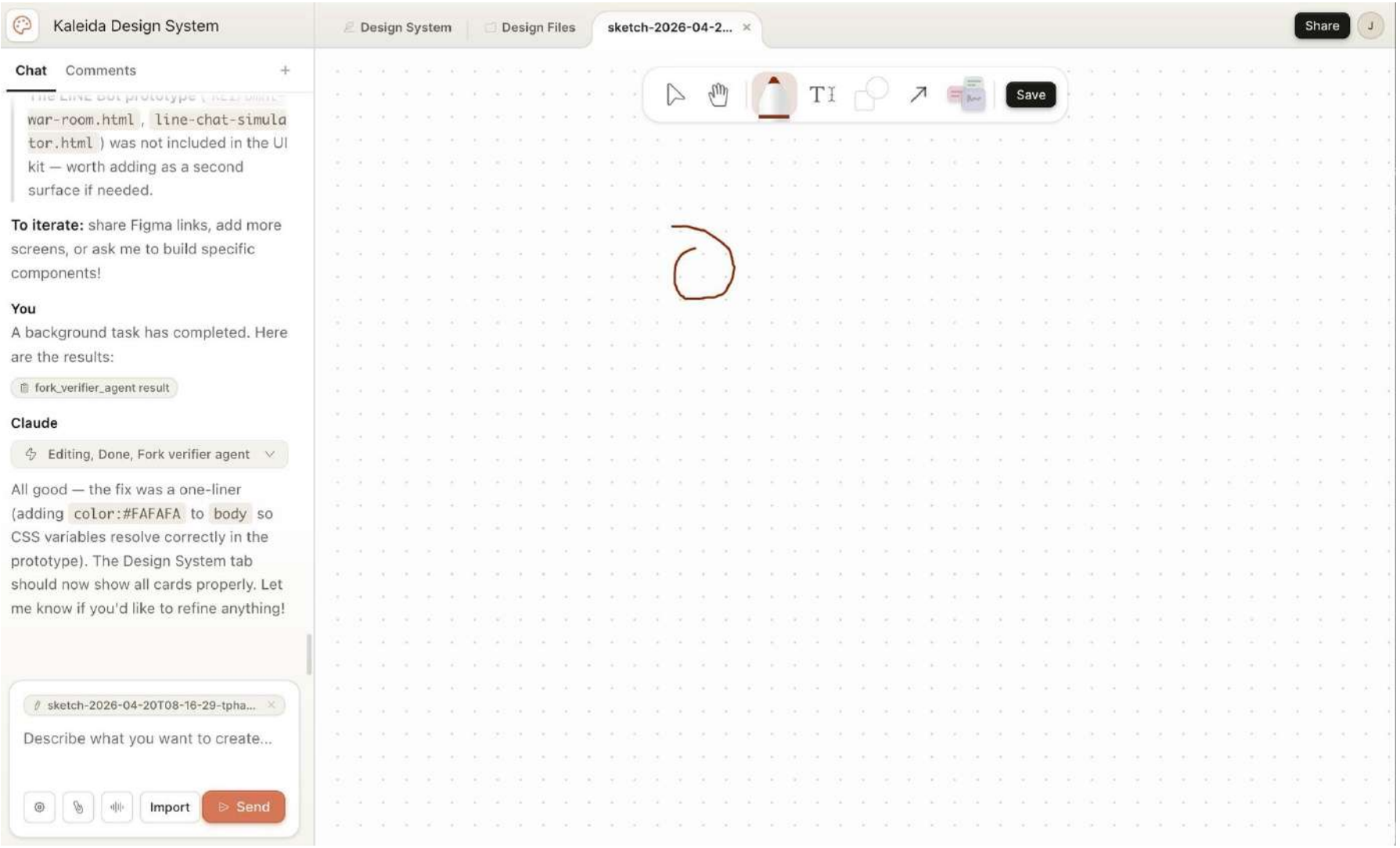
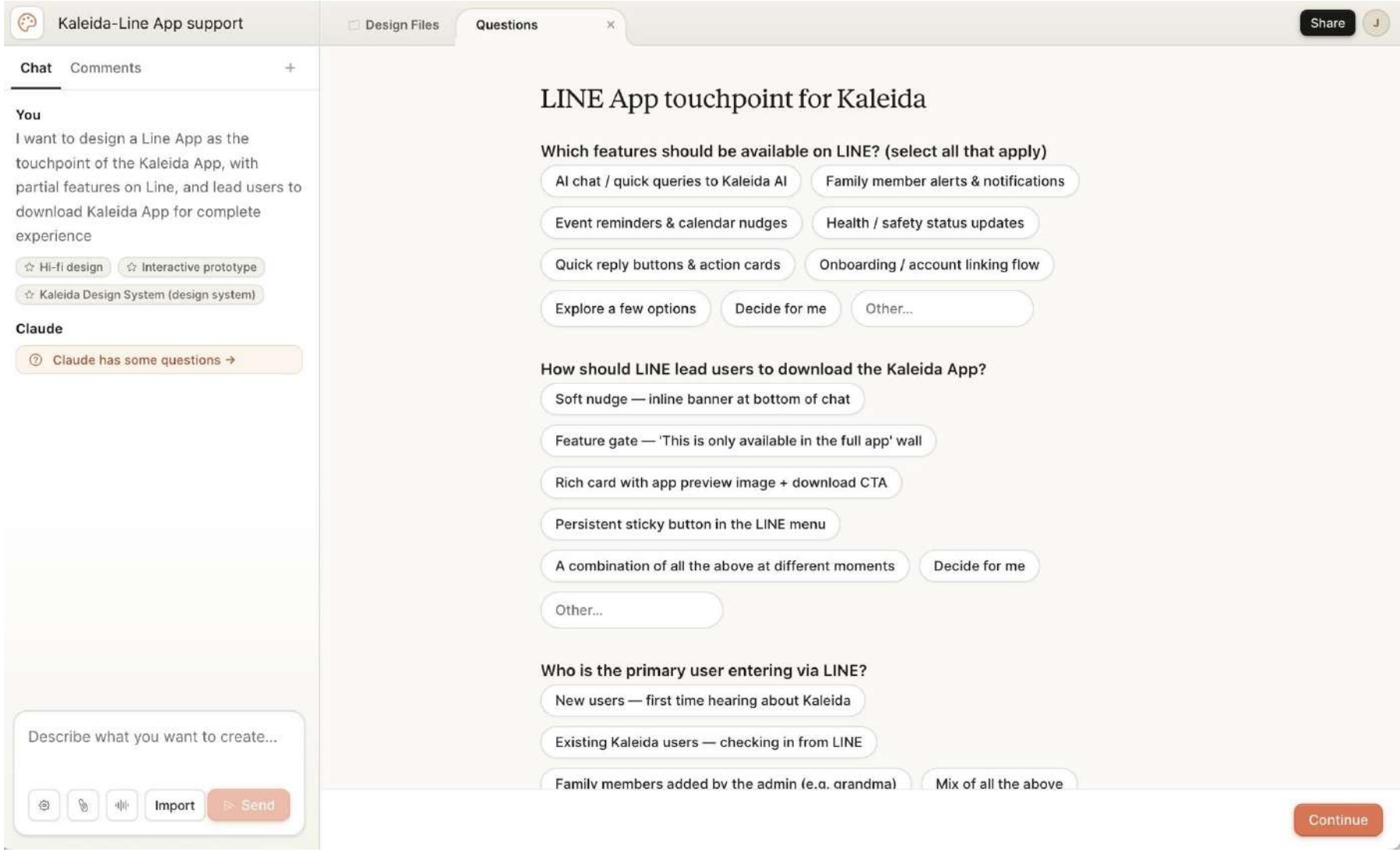
Sketch canva



Before starting – design decisions

Claude Design asks users to decide in forms



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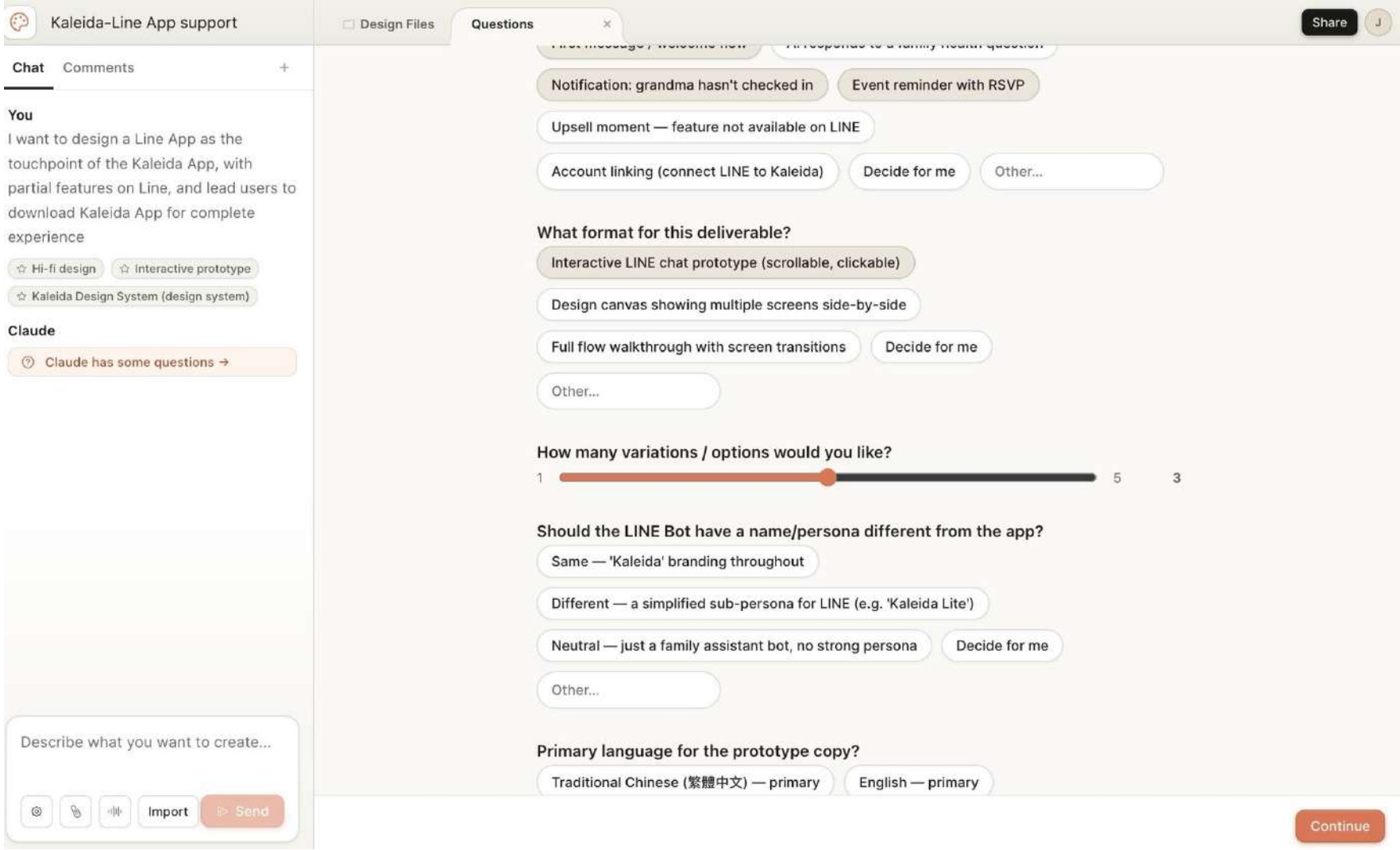
Before starting – design decisions

Claude Design asks users to decide in forms



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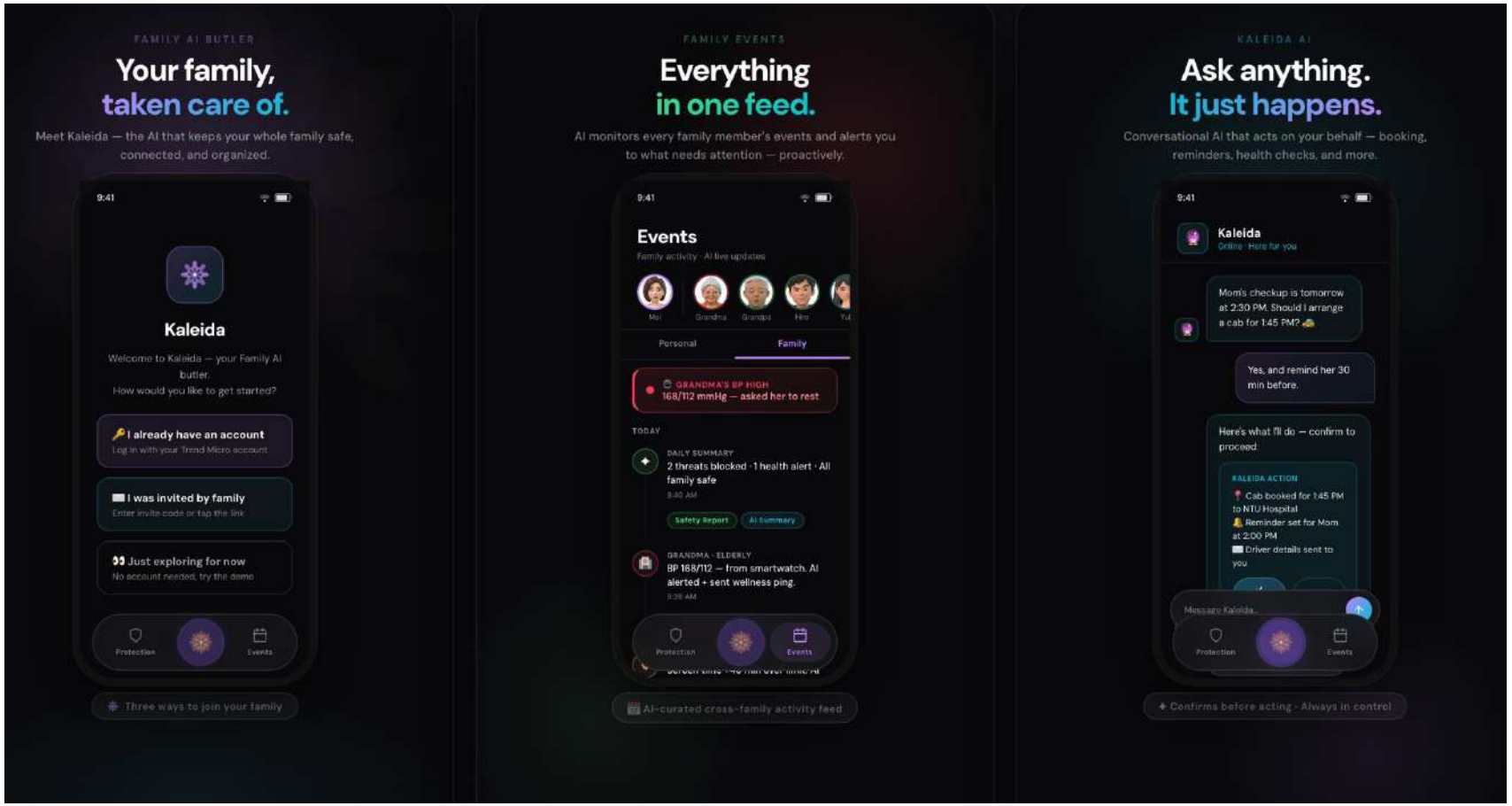
Outcome

https://claude.ai/design/p/2fa7898e-972a-437b-ae77-54c745d0d76c?file=Play+Store+Screenshots+v2.html&via=share



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Low barrier. Narrower range.

Pick the tool by scenario, not by preference.

Claude Design 的 GUI 更易上手，但 Claude Code 依然涵蓋較多場景。
下方是結構性差異 — 這些是「依場景選工具」的依據。

Claude Design 做不到的	影響的場景
Team shared skills / documents	跨人、跨專案共用規則做不了 — 每人重貼
Workspace-level instruction	組織級 convention 無法持久注入
Skill runner	無法跑自動化檢查、lint、commit、sync
MCP / hooks	無法接 Jira / Teams / cron 自動化需求流
Decision trace	無法稽核、無 git blame、決策不可追

“It’s not a design tool as much as it’s a design production tool. Design is methodical; like architecture, not like art.”
— Rasmus Andersson (@rsms)

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CONCLUSION · FOR OUR SCENARIO

Pick the tool by the job.

A Pure visual validation · cross-team review

Claude Design is the main stage.

- Org-internal share URL for stakeholder review
- Inline comments · live canvas iteration
- One-click export to PDF / PPTX / Canva
- Team-project workspaces — shared folders · inline comments (Team / Enterprise plan)

B Better harness · version-control

Claude Design's limits push you to Claude Code.

Design system	No auto-sync — updates need manual Remix
Version control	No rollback · tokens are a black box · can't diff
Requirements intake	Every update pasted by hand (no MCP / cron)
Figma export	No official path — third-party tools required

A · USE CLAUDE DESIGN WHEN

- Concept ideation · stakeholder review decks
- Marketing one-pagers · pitch artifacts

B · REACH FOR CLAUDE CODE WHEN

- Cross-function traceable collaboration — PM ↔ design ↔ RD
- Live ingest of requirements, design system, policy updates

What's Next

01

Evaluate long-term outcomes

Measure ongoing impact, not one-time production quality.

02

Cross-team handover

How designs travel across people, teams, and time.

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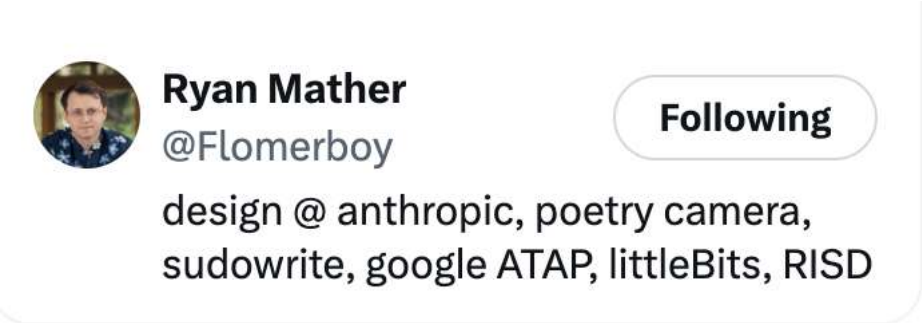
“

It's easy to get sucked into the hyper speed of agentic designing.

Knowing when to slow down is an art form of its own.

— Ryan Mather, design @ Anthropic



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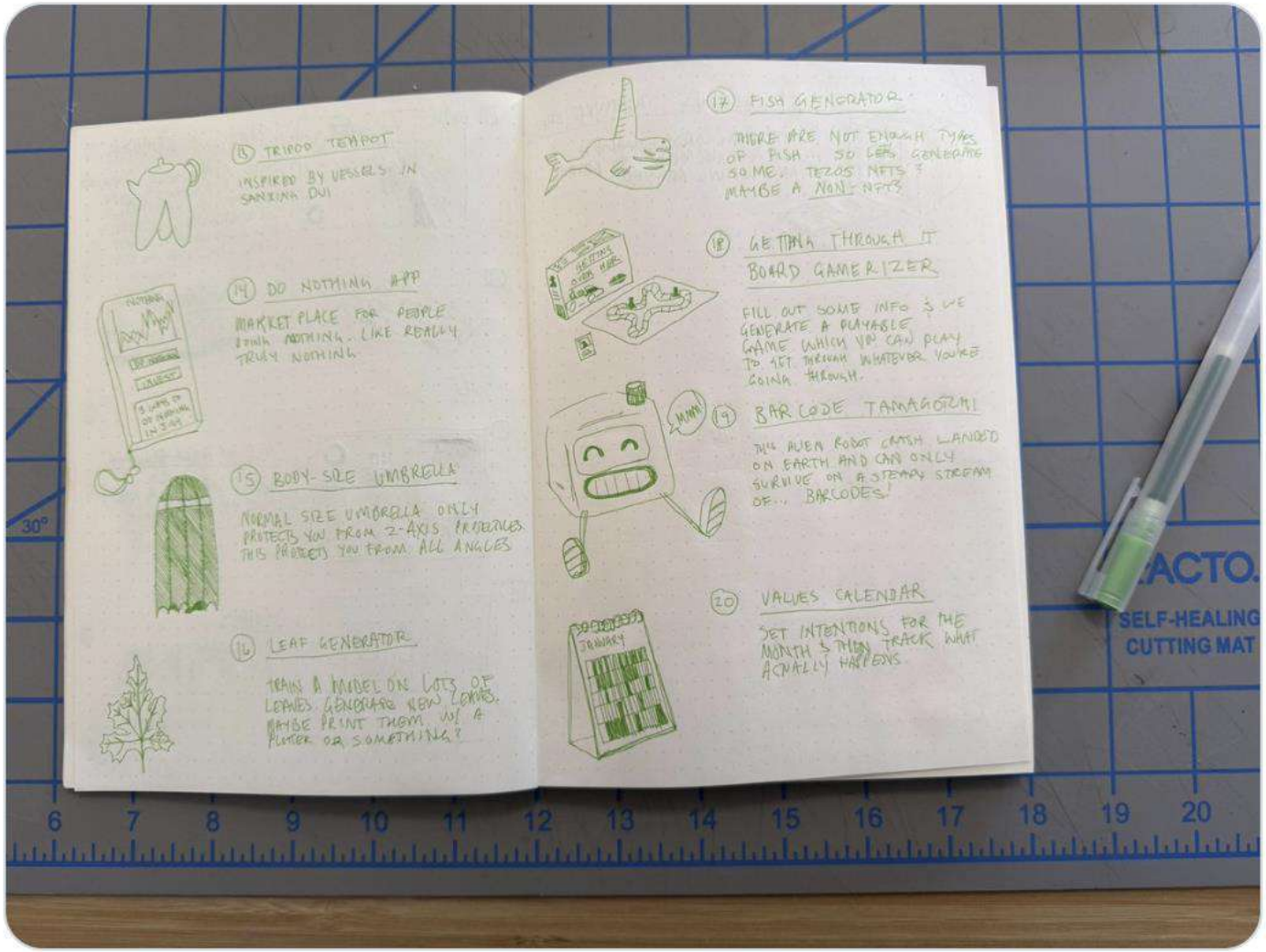
Ryan Mather @Flomerboy · 14h

Lastly, for the most abstract and reflective design work, I still recommend a pen + paper! My favorite are MD product notebook (FKA Midori MD paper) and Muji .38mm gel pens.



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Update

電腦王阿達 . (2026, April 21). Claude Design 剛推出就被逆向開源!Huashu Design:一句 prompt 就能生出原型、簡報與 MP4 動畫 - 電腦王阿達 https://www.koc.com.tw/archives/639936

Claude Design 剛推出就被逆向開源?

進入「設計方向顧問模式」——從 20 種設計哲學推 3 個差異化方向讓用戶選

和 Claude Design 的關係

我大方承認：品牌資產協議的哲學是從 Claude Design 流傳出來的提示詞裡偷師的。那份提示詞反覆強調好的高保真設計不是從白紙開始，而是從已有的設計上下文長出來。這個原則是 65 分作品和 90 分作品的分水嶺。

定位差異：

	Claude Design	huashu-design
形態	網頁產品（瀏覽器裡用）	skill（Claude Code 裡用）
配額	訂閱 quota	API 消耗 · 平行跑 agent 不受 quota 限
交付物	畫布內 + 可導 Figma	HTML / MP4 / GIF / 可編輯 PPTX / PDF
操作方式	GUI（點、拖、改）	對話（說話、等 agent 做完）
複雜動畫	有限	Stage + Sprite 時間軸 · 60fps 匯出
跨 agent	專屬 Claude.ai	任意 skill 相容 agent

Claude Design 是更好的圖形工具，huashu-design 是讓圖形工具這層消失。兩條路，不同受眾。

Both anti AI slop = AI 預設產出的「視覺最大公約數」
— 紫漸層、emoji icon、圓角卡片、AI 手畫 SVG。

只要 agent 是「為某個具體品牌」工作，而不是「為 AI 平均值」工作，slop 就不會發生。

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References

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2. Claude (@claudeai) launch post on X — x.com/claudeai/status/2045156267690213649

3. Ryan Mather (@Flomerboy) — Tips for Claude Design — x.com/Flomerboy/status/2045162321589252458

4. Claude Design — claude.ai/design

5. Figma Skills: Code to design workflows — figma.com/community/skills

6. Rasmus Andersson (@rsms) — Quote — x.com/rsms/status/2045239193971179851

7. 達小編. (2026, April 21). Claude Design 剛推出就被逆向開源!Huashu Design:一句 prompt 就能生出原型、簡報與 MP4 動畫 - 電腦王阿達. 電腦王阿達. https://www.koc.com.tw/archives/639936